

CASE STUDY

When your data is in five places, your decisions are based on one of them.

Non-asset-based logistics is a margin business. Knowing which carriers are most cost-effective, which customers are most profitable, and how the business is performing financially, in real time, is the difference between growing margins and eroding them.

SmartWay Transportation had the data. It was just in three different systems with no connection between them. Armely built that connection using Power BI, and the view that resulted changed how the business makes decisions.

Who is SmartWay Transportation?

SmartWay Transportation LLC is a non-asset-based logistics provider headquartered in Kansas City, Missouri. They manage full and partial truckload freight across a national carrier network, offering flatbed, reefer, specialty, and dry van services alongside tailored logistics management solutions. As the business grew, the gap between their operational complexity and their reporting capability became a constraint on decision-making.

3

Data Sources Unified
TMS, CRM, accounting software

3

Power BI Dashboards Built
Load, sales, and executive views

1

Source of Truth
Centralized data warehouse

The Problem

SmartWay's data was accurate within each system. The transportation management system knew what loads were moving. The CRM knew what customers were engaged. The accounting software knew what the numbers were. But none of those systems talked to each other, and getting a complete picture of the business required pulling from all three, manually, and reconciling them by hand.

The executive team received periodic reports assembled from separate department exports. By the time those reports were in hand, the data was already dated and the picture they presented was incomplete.

The sales team tracked performance metrics in spreadsheets alongside the CRM. There was no systematic way to see which customers were most profitable, which lanes had the best margins, or how individual sales performance compared to team targets.

Carrier performance was tracked operationally but not analytically. The logistics team had no dashboard view of which carriers were most reliable and cost-effective across load types and lanes.

Trend analysis, scenario planning, and forecasting required manual modeling. The business was growing, but the reporting infrastructure wasn't growing with it.

Signs your reporting is holding your business back:

- Executive reports are assembled by hand from multiple systems
- Sales performance exists in spreadsheets, not in your CRM or BI tool
- You can't answer which customers or lanes are most profitable without manual analysis
- Carrier performance is tracked operationally but never analyzed
- Decisions are made on reports that were current last week, not today

What Armely Built

The solution connected SmartWay's three data sources to a centralized data warehouse, then built Power BI dashboards on top of that unified layer. Three dashboards were developed, each tailored to the team and decisions it was built to support.

Data Integration

SmartWay's transportation management system, CRM, and accounting software were connected to a centralized data warehouse. This consolidation created a single source of truth for all reporting, eliminating the need for manual data pulls from each system and the reconciliation errors that came with them.

Load Factoring Dashboard

The logistics team received a dashboard covering load volumes, revenue per load, cost per load, and carrier performance metrics across load types and lanes. The dashboard gave the operations team the ability to identify the most reliable and cost-effective carriers, compare margins across load types, and spot operational inefficiencies that manual reporting had obscured.

Sales Performance Dashboard

The sales team gained visibility into individual and team-level performance metrics: revenue, win/loss rates, customer engagement, and profitability by customer and lane. For the first time, sales leadership could see which customers and segments were driving margin and which were consuming effort without proportional return.

Executive Dashboard

Leadership received a real-time view of the company's financial performance, operational KPIs, and progress against strategic initiatives, all in one place. The executive dashboard replaced the periodic, assembled-by-hand report with a live view that was available whenever it was needed.

Data Modeling and Analytics

Armely built the underlying data models to support not just current reporting but future analytical capability: trend analysis across time periods, scenario planning for pricing and margin decisions, and predictive forecasting as the data history accumulated. The models were designed to extend, so as SmartWay's reporting needs grew, the foundation was already in place.

Training and Adoption

Hands-on training and ongoing support ensured SmartWay's staff could use the dashboards from day one. Adoption was built into the implementation, not treated as an afterthought.

Before	After
Data scattered across TMS, CRM, and accounting, no unified view	All sources connected to a centralized data warehouse
Manual reporting: hours spent assembling periodic exports	Live Power BI dashboards available in real time to all stakeholders
No carrier performance analytics, only operational tracking	Load Factoring Dashboard: revenue per load, cost, carrier performance by lane
Sales tracked in spreadsheets alongside the CRM	Sales Performance Dashboard: revenue, win/loss, profitability by customer
Executive reports fragmented, delayed, assembled manually	Executive Dashboard: real-time financial and operational KPIs unified
No trend analysis or forecasting capability	Data models built for trend analysis, scenario planning, and forecasting

What Changed

SmartWay's leadership team sees the business in real time. The logistics team identifies carrier performance problems before they affect margins. The sales team knows which customers are profitable and which aren't. Everyone is working from the same data, not separate exports that tell different stories.

The shift from periodic, manually assembled reporting to live dashboards is not just a time savings. It changes the quality of decisions that get made, because the information those decisions are based on is current, complete, and consistent.

"The Power BI implementation transformed the way SmartWay uses data to drive business performance and achieve its strategic objectives as a non-asset-based logistics provider."

— Armely, LLC

About Armely

Armely is a Dallas-based Microsoft solutions partner. Founded in 2017, we serve over 50 clients across energy, healthcare, government, and manufacturing. Our services cover Microsoft Dynamics 365, Microsoft Fabric, Power Platform, data analytics, and AI implementation. We work as an extension of your team, from initial strategy through deployment and ongoing support.

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See what your data can tell you when it's all in one place.

Armely offers a free analytics review for logistics and operations companies. We look at your data sources, your reporting setup, and what your team needs to make better decisions. You get a clear picture of what a unified BI solution would look like for your business.

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